



NARRATIVE REPORT FOR JULY 2025

INTRODUCTION

The month of July was a remarkable and eventful period for Kenya Keys, marked by celebration, reflection, and renewed inspiration. As the organization commemorated its 20th anniversary, we had the distinct honor of welcoming long-time sponsors and supporters from the USA, including Mama Rinda, the beloved co-founder of Kenya Keys. Their presence not only added joy and meaning to the celebrations but also served as a powerful reminder of the journey we have traveled and the lives we have impacted over the past two decades.

Throughout the month, various activities were organized to celebrate this significant milestone, foster stronger community ties, and showcase the achievements and ongoing work of the organization. This report captures the highlights of key engagements, and the overall impact of the activities held in July.

1. Welcoming and naming ceremony at Bahakwenu primary school.

One of the most memorable events with June/July team was the Sponsors' Welcoming and Naming Ceremony held on 30/6/2025 at Bahakwenu Primary School—a place of deep historical and emotional significance for Kenya Keys. It was here, 20 years ago, that the organization began its journey of unlocking potential through education sponsorship. Returning to this foundational site made the occasion not just a celebration, but a powerful moment of reflection and gratitude.

The event brought together a large and vibrant crowd, including community members, alumni, students, and Kenya Keys partners, all gathered to honor the legacy of transformation that began at Bahakwenu. The atmosphere was alive with joy, pride, and cultural expression.

Guests were warmly welcomed with traditional dances, heartfelt songs, and speeches from beneficiaries who shared moving testimonies of how Kenya Keys has impacted their lives. A special tree-planting

ceremony was held in honor of the visiting sponsors—symbolizing growth, longevity, and the deep roots Kenya Keys has planted in the community.

Students presented a range of themed entertainment pieces, creatively expressing their appreciation for the education sponsorship, mentorship, and infrastructure support provided by Kenya Keys over the years.

This event not only rekindled the spirit of Kenya Keys’ mission but also celebrated the unity and progress of a community that continues to thrive because of it.



The colorful welcoming ceremony at Bahakwenu primary school

2. Ndohivyo Special Olympics

Another key highlight of the sponsors’ visit in July was the Special Olympics held at Ndohivyo Special School, an event made possible through the generous support of the Bill Self family. This heartwarming day brought together children with special needs, their caregivers, staff, sponsors, and community members for a celebration of inclusion, joy, and athletic spirit.

The day began with a colorful procession from Samburu Town to Ndohivyo School, with sponsors walking alongside students, staff, and supporters. This symbolic march not only marked the beginning of the event but also reflected the solidarity and shared purpose of those committed to empowering every child, regardless of ability.

A wide range of games and sports activities were held throughout the day, tailored to engage and excite the special needs students. Their energy and enthusiasm lit up the event, showcasing not only their abilities but also their confidence and determination. A special highlight was the participation of

the short-stature football team from Kalimbo, who brought a spirited performance and inclusive message to the event.

Adding to the fun and sense of unity, both Kenya Keys staff and the visiting USA team actively participated in the games, creating memorable moments of laughter, teamwork, and connection. The inclusive spirit of the day ensured that every student who participated received a medal, symbolizing recognition, encouragement, and achievement.

This event not only offered joy and empowerment to the students of Ndohivyo but also strengthened the bonds between Kenya Keys, the community, and its global partners—showing the power of sports to bring people together and celebrate every child's potential.





Ndohivyo students with July interns during the special Olympics day.

3. Karimani Primary School Handover of Three Classrooms

On 4th July, Kenya Keys staff, U.S. interns, and visitors from the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints attended the official handover ceremony of three newly constructed classrooms to Karimani Primary School. The Church funded the classrooms following a successful proposal by Kenya Keys on behalf of the school.

The development marked a significant milestone in the transformation of Karimani Primary School, which Kenya Keys alumni initiated. Previously, students learned in mud-walled classrooms, with the community making considerable sacrifices to erect temporary structures. The school's establishment aimed to reduce the long distances learners traveled to access education and to safeguard them from the risk of wild animal attacks, given the proximity to a national park.

The ceremony was also part of the U.S. interns' itinerary of school visits, allowing them to witness first-hand the realities local schools face, the progress made through Kenya Keys' initiatives, and the strength of strategic partnerships.

The event brought together local authorities, parents, community members, students, partners, and friends of the school to celebrate a project that will enhance the learning environment, improve safety, and promote equitable access to education in the community.



Officially launching of the Church of latter days project at Karimani primary school.

4. Kenya keys @ 20 Celebration

On 5th July Kenya Keys proudly celebrated its 20th anniversary of unlocking students' potential through sponsorship—a significant milestone highlighting two decades of impact in Kwale County and beyond.

Since its founding, Kenya Keys has supported needy and bright students through education sponsorship, mentorship programs, and the development of school infrastructure. These achievements, along with many inspiring success stories, were beautifully documented in the Kenya Keys @ 20 Magazine.

The celebration was marked by the official opening of the Community Education Centre, now the largest library and education hub in Kwale County. This state-of-the-art facility stands as a symbol of hope and opportunity, offering students and the wider community access to vital learning resources.

The day began with a colorful procession from Taru town to the Kenya Keys offices, setting the tone for a vibrant and heartfelt event. Guests were welcomed with energetic performances by traditional dancers, followed by student presentations—songs, poems, and drama pieces—celebrating Kenya Keys' 20-year journey and the lives transformed along the way.

In attendance were community members, local partners, students, the Kenya Keys Kenya Board of Directors, and a delegation from the USA sponsor team, whose presence highlighted the deep partnership and global support behind Kenya Keys' mission.

Speeches from various guests reflected on the incredible growth and success achieved over the years, and reaffirmed a collective commitment to continue unlocking potential through education for generations to come.



20 years anniversary celebration, a great day it was!

5. Tsavo Safari with the US Team

As part of the 20th anniversary celebration for Kenya Keys, both the Kenyan and US teams were treated to an unforgettable, adventure-filled safari to Tsavo – a generous and thoughtful gift from the Gordon family.

From the moment we set out, the excitement was tangible – especially for many of us experiencing a safari for the very first time. We had the incredible opportunity to see majestic wildlife including lions,

elephants, giraffes, zebras, buffaloes, and so much more. Every moment spent in nature offered wonder, awe, and a deep sense of connection – not only with the wildlife but with each other.

Beyond the thrilling game drives, we also enjoyed deliciously prepared meals and a peaceful, relaxed environment – a refreshing break after an intense and productive week. The safari provided a perfect space for bonding, reflection, and celebration.

We are deeply grateful to the Gordon family for this amazing opportunity – your generosity created lasting memories and brought both teams even closer together. Thank you for making this special milestone truly remarkable.



Great moments at Tsavo during the safari

6. Goal ball hosting at Community Education Centre Hall.

It was truly exciting to see the Community Education Centre Hall being utilized just 2 weeks after its official opening, a clear sign of its immediate impact. What made this moment even more special was that the very first event held in the new hall was dedicated to children with visual impairments.

We had the incredible opportunity to host a Goalball tournament for visually impaired students from across the Coast region. The event was not only fun and engaging, but also meaningful. Most importantly, the hall offered a safe, inclusive, and accessible environment, perfectly suited to the unique needs of the students.

This thoughtful investment has already begun transforming lives, not only serving our community but also empowering people with disabilities. Features like the wheelchair-accessible ramp and special washrooms were deeply appreciated by teachers and participants. Many were amazed that such a disability-inclusive facility now exists in Taru, something that had long been needed.

It was a heartwarming and exciting experience for our staff, students, and the entire team. We are grateful for this impactful addition to our community, a space that truly reflects inclusion, opportunity, and hope.



Goal ball game for visually impaired at CEC Hall.

Apart from the above activities that called for collaboration and teamwork across all departments, several other impactful activities were also carried out by the departments within the organization.

Below are some of the noteworthy departmental activities carried out during the month of July:

SPONSORSHIP DEPARTMENT

The month of July marked yet another impactful chapter for the Sponsorship Department as the department remained steadfast in its commitment to walking hand in hand with our students throughout their educational journey. Guided by our mission to unlock potential through education, our team worked diligently to ensure that each sponsored student received the personalized support, encouragement, and resources they needed to thrive academically and personally.

The Department successfully carried out the following activities during the month:

1. US Interns interaction with students and interviews.

The first week of July was a very busy week. The sponsorship team had a series of events planned out for with the US team.

(a) Student-Sponsor Meetings

On 05/07/25, during the celebrations of the Kenya Keys' 20th anniversary, sponsors were given time to interact and catch up with their students. These included mostly college students, some alumni and one secondary school student. They got to do this before the event started, some during and others at the time of dinner.

These heartfelt encounters allowed sponsored students to express gratitude, share their progress, and build personal connections with their sponsors. The meetings were filled with emotional moments and strengthened the bond that fuels student motivation and sponsor engagement. The older alumni had secured good jobs and settled down with families of their own. This portrayed the progress the program has made, the lives touched and the potential unlocked.

(b) Student Interviews

The interviews took place on 04/07/25. This involved secondary school students, four girls from Mackinnon Road girls, three from Taru girls and four from Samburu Boys.

The interviews were successful and provided essential insight into students' academic performance, home situations, and future aspirations. This process also helped in identifying cases requiring additional psychosocial or academic support.



Sponsors interacting with their students

2. HEF and HELB loan applications

This is a government initiative in Kenya that provides financial aid to students who want to pursue higher education. This model uses an eligibility criterion that identifies the level of need in every applicant, to make sure every learner gets funded as per their level of need.

Before the introduction of Higher Education Finance, the students that qualified for university did not have to make any applications and would automatically get government scholarships through their higher education. With the current changes, it is mandatory to inform students before they sit for their KCSE that they will have to apply to be assisted financially before they join University and the TVETS. It has become especially a headache for the students coming from families that are far away from civilization who do not even have access to mobile phones, let alone the internet. Some places do not even have cyber cafes to help students, and the distance from their homes to the nearest town calls for logistical expenses.

On 02/07/25, the HEF and UF announced that the portal was open for undergraduate and TVET students to apply for their first year loans and funds. The sponsorship team immediately informed the students of this so that they could access the office and get assistance in applying for these scholarships, since the process needs a lot of keenness to maximize on the chances of being awarded at least 90 % funding, which all Kenya Keys students deserve given their level of need and vulnerability.

All the Kenya Keys from four graduates from around Taru visited the office to be helped with their applications. As usual, a number of non-Kenya Keys students also came to the office to be assisted. This shows that the organization is centrally placed and comes in handy to the welfare of the community, without discriminating its services from those who are not directly tied to it.



HEF and HELB loan applications going on with sponsorship team.

3. Clearance from secondary school

After completing KCSE, before leaving for home, it is a requirement that form four graduates clear from their respective schools. This entails making sure that they have returned everything they have that belongs to the school to all the respective departments. Without doing this, they cannot be given their academic documents once they go for them. If they have lost anything that was given to them, they are required to pay for it and get a stamp of approval from the administration.

The sponsorship team coordinated with students and their schools to make sure that they are assisted through their clearance process. They were sorted with the remedial and ream paper payment but they had to pay for anything that they had lost themselves. Luckily, most of them had not lost a lot of items given to them by the schools. This was essential because on admission to college, they are required to have their result slips and leaving certificates which are only provided if the student has cleared all the balances from school.

4. College admission preparation

Every year, the graduates are adequately prepared before they are admitted in college and university. Their admission forms are downloaded, printed and their fees structures and financial documents forwarded to the finance department for budgeting purposes. The staff helps the learners go through their admission forms to ensure that they understand all the information that is enclosed in them. This ensures that they are aware of all the requirements like acceptance forms, identification cards, parents identification and personal health records before they leave home for school. All this is to avoid any inconveniences on the day of admission.

The team assists both the Kenya Keys and non Kenya-Keys students. For the non Kenya Keys students, they are mainly encouraged to try their best and prepare as best they can. They are assisted to apply for Higher Education Funding which secures their chance of getting into higher learning institutions which eliminates the worry of lack of school fees, at least. They are usually told prior to raising the transport money and a few commodities that they will need in school like toiletries and basic accessories.

Otherwise, they are assured that they will enroll in college just like everyone else, all they need are the basic items, HEF and Helb funds which will aid in their survival in college.



James Kenya Keys staff assisting students

5. Items brought by the US interns in July

Every time the US team visits Kenya, they bring along with them technological items that are critical for supporting students in their studies. Most of the time, they bring with them laptops and flash drives. In the month of July, they brought 14 laptops and 70 flash drives. The laptops are given to students enrolling in Teacher Training Programmes, engineering courses and ICT programmes. These courses require students to have a working laptop and sometimes the students are not enrolled in school without a laptop. Since the laptops are not enough for all the college students, the students in the above categories are given the first priority.

The flash drives, on the other hand, are usually given to all the freshmen joining college. These help them when they are in school and need to export and store important study material that is usually given to them by the lecturers. The flash drives also come in handy when students are working on their project proposals, reports and assignments. When they get access to a laptop either in the library or ICT room, if their school has the privilege of access to adequate technology, they can utilize that, work on their tasks and comfortably export their work and use it whenever they want to.



6. General correspondence

Kenya Keys continues to receive visitors every day, from parents, students and even random visitors inquiring about the community education center, which has been drawing positive attention from even passersby. Parents have been continuously coming to request for different types of assistance for their children, from school fees, academic and career advice. This shows how Kenya Keys continues to be of great significance when it comes to solving most of the societal problems surrounding the Taru community, from day to day.



Students applying for sponsorship

LIBRARY DEPARTMENT

The month of July has been a truly inspirational chapter in the story of the Kenya keys community library. It was a month filled with deep connection, creativity, meaningful learning, and unforgettable moments. From hosting our cherished U.S visitors to engaging with schools and adult learners and organizing interschool academic forums, every activity has strengthened our mission to uplift the Taru community through education and opportunity. Below are some of the key activities that were carried out:

1. A visit by US team to our community library and non-formal education Centre (NFE)

We were honored to host a visit by the US team to our Community Library and the Taru Non-Formal Education Centre. The Community Library, a proud initiative of Kenya Keys, serves learners of all ages and is fully stocked with a wide variety of books a generous gift from our dedicated sponsors.

The team also toured the Taru Non-Formal Education Centre, where they witnessed the powerful impact of adult education in our community. This Centre provides vital learning opportunities for adults who did not have access to formal schooling, helping to empower individuals and transform lives.

It was a day of inspiration, shared stories, and strengthened partnerships, a true celebration of education at every stage of life.



NFE students with the U.S. interns and the Kenya keys librarian taking through the visitor on the library activities

2. Mural painting activity with Fuleye primary school learners.

Twenty learners from the above-mentioned school, accompanied by their deputy headteacher, took part in the 3-day mural painting event at the CEC (kids' library section). With brushes in hand and hearts full of ideas, the children created a colorful and meaningful mural that now brightens our walls. The mural symbolizes not only creativity but also the strength of partnerships between schools and the library.



Some beautiful photos taken during the mural painting event at the CEC –kids' library section.

3. Inter-School Book Discussion

One of the most exciting activities in July was the Inter-School Book Discussion, which brought together students from five schools, including both boys and girls. Each school was represented by 15 students for the book discussion and 5 students for the Maths Club.

The highlight of the event was the lively and thoughtful discussion on the novel *Hatchet* by Gary Paulsen. Students engaged deeply with the themes of survival, resilience, and personal growth portrayed in the story. The session encouraged critical thinking, confidence in expression, and a shared love for reading across the participating schools.

Math club discussion was mainly to encourage peer learning and creative problem solving and for the anatomy class was offering a focused, hands-on learning experience in biology.

It was a vibrant, inspiring day that reinforced the power of books and education in bringing young minds together. At the close of the session, certificates of participation were awarded to all students- a proud moment for the learners



Students from different schools with some of the US team during the book discussion session at Taru girls.

4. Library supplies sorting and inventory preparation.

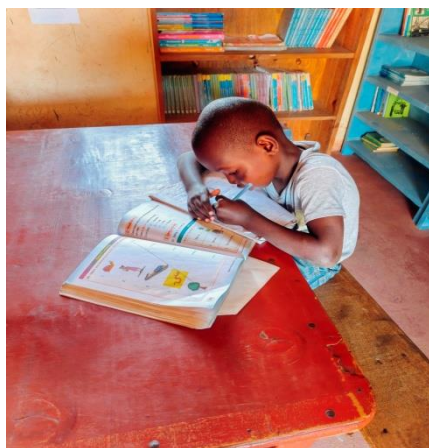
The department received a generous donation of books and educational materials for the visiting U.S team. The sorting, labeling and documenting of these new supplies was done. A full inventory was created to ensure proper management and accessibility of these new additions to our resource pool. The inventory was comprised of 204 books with 8 anatomy full kits, 5 educational games and 2 sets of small whiteboards with their erasers. The supplies can in when our learners needed them the most.

5. Book tittle search and order placing.

Responding to feedback from readers and analyzing curriculum trends, the library department conducted a comprehensive book title search. A list of titles needed was compiled, and an order was successfully placed to ensure our shelves remain current and supportive of diverse learning needs. This order for the year 2025 was fully funded by Carolyn's mother-in-law, Anona Kuehne. As the library department we really appreciate your generous donation. Your kindness is an investment in knowledge and its impact will be felt by readers of all ages for years to come. As we look forward to filling our new library bookshelves which is 20 times bigger than the current one, your contribution will play a vital role.

6. Evening story book reading and game play sessions.

Our library evenings came alive with cheerful story reading and interactive game session for children. These sessions continue to provide a safe space for joyful learning, imagination, and social development.



A photo of a young learner doing some school tasks at the library.

7. Library service desk

July recorded high attendance at the library with increased book circulation. Our service desk offered excellent consultation services to students and adult community members alike. With consistent follow-ups on borrowed books, we maintained a high level of responsibility and engagement from our readers.

Here is the library statistics for the month.

- Total number of visitors **345**
- Books borrowed **132**
- Books returned to the shelves **84**
- Books renewed **48**

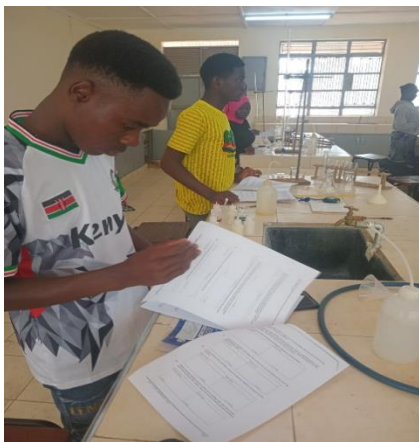
8. Non formal education (NFE) practical session and end of term 2 exam

During term two in the month of July in specific, NFE students undertook both their in class practical sessions and end of term examinations. Despite not having a dedicated laboratory of their own, the students were able to participate fully in science practicals, thanks to the generous support of Kenya keys organization.

Kenya keys facilitated the practical sessions by covering the cost for laboratory specimen at Taru boys' secondary school and also provided compensation for the science facilitators overseeing the sessions. These practicals have been instrumental in bridging the gap between theoretical knowledge and hands-on experience, particularly in science subjects such as biology, chemistry and physics.

This practical exposure is essential in preparing them adequately for national examinations and boosting their confidence in scientific subjects.

On the other side, the end of term 2 exams were successful administered and marked a significant milestone in the academic journey of the NFE learners. They remain grateful to Kenya keys for the continued commitment and support in ensuring equal access to quality education for all students regardless of their background.



NFE students doing their in-class practical's at Taru boys laboratory

GENDER AND AFFIRMATIVE ACTION DEPARTMENT

July was a highly active and productive month for the GAA Department. With the presence of U.S. interns, the midterm break for high school students, and several key programs, including Usalama, VSS, and Nyango Menstrual Cup training, distribution, and feedback collection. The month was packed with meaningful initiatives.

The presence of the U.S. interns was a valuable addition to the department, and their collaboration brought great energy and impact to the department's daily operations. Below is a summary of the key activities the department was directly involved in:

1. Visit to Samburu Sub-County Hospital

The GAA team, together with the U.S. interns, visited the newly upgraded Samburu Sub-County Hospital (formerly Samburu Health Centre), now a Level 4 facility offering a broader range of specialized services. One of the most inspiring moments of the visit was reconnecting with Grace Umazi, a proud Kenya Keys alumna, who is now serving in the orthopedic department of the hospital.

Seeing Grace in action was a powerful reminder of how education sponsorship is unlocking potential—transforming lives and enabling former students to give back to their communities in meaningful ways.

Beyond this touching encounter, the visit provided valuable insights into the healthcare challenges faced by the local community. The team identified key areas that require support to strengthen healthcare services and improve access to quality care.

This experience not only showcased the long-term impact of Kenya Keys' mission but also reinforced the importance of supporting both education and community development for a healthier, more empowered future.

2. S.O.S. / S.O.B. Club Engagement at Mgalani Secondary

The GAA department organized a forum at Mgalani Secondary School involving 30 students and teachers from various schools with active *Save Our Sisters (S.O.S)* and *Save Our Brothers (S.O.B)* clubs. The

purpose was to give the interns a better understanding of the importance of these student-led initiatives. Participants shared testimonials about how these clubs support students from underprivileged backgrounds, offering them a sense of security and belonging. The boys also shared impactful stories of how peer support through the clubs helped others feel safe and valued in school. The interns expressed deep appreciation for the students' passion and the transformative role these clubs play in their respective schools.



SOS and SOB clubs session with the US team and Kenyan staff.

3. Psychosocial Support

Beyond providing material assistance, the GAA Department also offers crucial psychological and educational support to students. In July, Kenya Keys, in collaboration with both the U.S. and Kenyan teams, organized general learning sessions for student representatives from all High schools around. These sessions were held at Mgalani Secondary School and covered topics such as General Mathematics, Human Anatomy and Physiology, History and Genesis.

The U.S. interns, supported by the GAA team, facilitated the classes, which aimed to equip students with both academic knowledge and life skills. Students gained valuable insights into managing emotional changes during adolescence, maintaining a positive attitude towards mathematics by understanding its real-life applications, identifying different types of human bones and their functions, and understanding the impact of the World Wars on modern society.



US team and students playing a game during the math session.



Genet, during the Genesis session.



During the Human anatomy session with Paul Rich and Genet.



During the History session with the great teller.

4. Tech-Lit Classes

As part of the scheduled itinerary, the U.S. team visited three of the four Tech-Lit classes within our service area. During these visits, they engaged with school heads, educators, and students, gaining firsthand insight into the program's impact. Students proudly showcased their projects, awards, and demonstrated how the Tech-Lit program is helping them integrate digital skills into their daily lives.

Many students confidently explained the processes behind their work and the progress they had made. Teachers' dedication was evident, as they remained available to support students whenever needed. The team also observed strong peer-to-peer support among learners. The Tech-Lit program continues to equip students with essential computer skills, preparing them for success in an increasingly digital world.



Tech-Lit session at Taru primary school.

5. Usalama Program

Kenya Keys continues to provide comprehensive support to the students it sponsors through the GAA Department under the Usalama Program. This support includes school shopping, transportation, medical assistance, academic trips, and uniform repair or replacement.

July marked the return to school for most students following the mid-term break. Many of these students come from economically disadvantaged backgrounds, and without timely intervention, they often face delays in reporting back to school or lack access to essential supplies.

During the month, the team successfully handled 50 Usalama cases. Notably, 7 of these cases involved non-Kenya Keys students who sought assistance from the office to enable their return to school.

6. Vital Student Support (V.S.S.)

The Vital Student Support (V.S.S.) program, under the Kenya Keys organization, is dedicated to supporting post-secondary students enrolled in colleges and universities. Through the GAA department, students receive essential support services including transport, upkeep, accommodation, medical assistance, and graduation fees upon completion of their studies.

This comprehensive support has enabled all sponsored students to report to college on time, maintain regular class attendance, and enhance their academic performance. In July, the team successfully handled 46 student support cases.

7. Nyango Village Outreach

In addition to academic sponsorship and basic needs support, Kenya Keys is committed to addressing menstrual poverty among vulnerable communities. As part of this initiative, the organization continues to empower girls and young mothers through menstrual health education and sustainable solutions. In July, the team conducted an outreach at Nyango village focused on training, distribution, and feedback collection for previously issued menstrual cups. The session was attended by 59 women:

- **35 participants** received in-depth training on menstrual cup usage, including insertion, removal, cleaning, and proper storage. They were also informed about the benefits of menstrual cups compared to other options. Many expressed interest and committed to trying the cups for at least three months.
- **24 participants** attended to provide feedback on their experience with the cups. The majority reported positive experiences and satisfaction with the product.

The outreach was highly successful, with strong engagement and promising outcomes from both new and returning participants.



Menstrual cups training and feedback collection, featuring Mr. Athanus ,the CEO Sports connect CBO.

MENTORSHIP DEPARTMENT

The month of July 2025 has been an incredibly impactful and eventful period for the Mentorship Department. As a vital arm of the organization, the Mentorship Department continues to uphold Kenya Keys' mission, to support education and ensure inclusivity for bright but needy students. This department plays a key role in shaping the lives of students through mentorship, counseling, and life coaching.

This month, the department's efforts were focused on below main objectives:

1. Handling needy students cases

One of the team's primary responsibilities this month was to respond to urgent and pressing needs of students, especially those in primary and junior secondary schools. The department received a total of KES 59,105 to handle these cases, broken down as follows:

- KES 54,400 from the Operations Department

- KES 4,500 from Mama Rinda (direct support)
- KES 205 balance brought forward

This funding was put to excellent use. A total of 42 students from various schools benefited from this initiative. The cases addressed included:

- Accumulated school fees. Some students were often sent home and some at risk of dropping out of school due to arrears, the mentors stepped in to reduce or clear their balances to keep them in school.
- Torn uniforms, several students were attending school in worn-out clothes, the team purchased new pairs of uniforms for them that were really tattered to restore their dignity and comfort. An outstanding case was of one student at Egu school. She is currently in grade 8. The girl had never gotten a JSS uniform since her joining. It's been two years since. The girl had requested her sister who is in form two to lend her her weekend dress that had the same shade as their JSS uniform. She reported that she admires being in a uniform like the others. Her father is a polygamous man and he stays with the second wife leaving the girl's mother to take care of her own children. The mother has never been able to buy the girl a school uniform.
- Special welfare support, One touching case involved a total orphan who was on the verge of starvation. Mentors provided him with two packets of maize flour to support him for a while as he waited for his guardian to secure an income.

This intervention not only addressed practical needs but also brought hope and emotional support to the affected students and their families



The girl who borrowed a dress, before and after she got a new pair of JSS uniform



Kombo, the boy who benefited with maize flour

2. Hope spring session with July US Interns

The US team had an opportunity to conduct a Hope Spring session held with the Hope Spring students of Magale Primary School, both mentors and US interns came together to interact, learn, and share experiences. The interns were especially eager to understand more about the Hope Spring Program and what it offers. They learned that the program focuses on life skills training, sexual and reproductive health (SRHS), drug abuse awareness, and general life coaching. These sessions are designed to help students face real-life challenges with confidence. Through interactive discussions and real-life examples, the students are guided on how to make wise decisions and overcome obstacles in life, eventually emerging stronger and more focused.

The US interns were impressed by the way the program connects with the students on a personal level, helping them grow both emotionally and mentally. They praised the program for nurturing talents, building self-esteem, and teaching empathy, qualities that are vital in today's world. The interns highlighted how important it is for young people to gain such knowledge early in life, especially in communities facing various challenges. They recommended the Hope Spring Program as a powerful tool that not only educates but also inspires students to dream bigger and live better.





Featuring is James facilitating the Hope Spring session at Magale primary school with US interns.

3. Hope Spring program graduations

Another major achievement for the Mentorship Department in July was the successful graduation of students from the Hope Spring Program. This program is designed to empower students with knowledge, skills, and values that promote holistic development and responsible behavior. It focuses on three key areas:

- Life skills development such as decision-making, problem-solving, communication, goal setting, emotional intelligence, self-esteem, and confidence building. These skills equip students to navigate life more effectively, both in and out of school. The goal is to ensure that students are equipped with the necessary skills to navigate life challenges.
- Drug and substance abuse prevention, this part of the program educates students on the dangers of drugs and substance misuse, helping them make informed choices and resist peer pressure.
- Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR), students are taught about bodily autonomy, hygiene, puberty, reproductive health, and safe practices to help them protect themselves and make responsible decisions.

The first phase of the program, which started earlier in the year, concluded in July with graduation ceremonies held across all 9 Kenya Keys service schools. The Mentorship team organized and facilitated these graduations, visiting two schools each day over the course of a week.

During each graduation event:

- Students shared personal reflections and testimonies on what they learned. Most of them portrayed confidence as they spoke, a true reflection that the teaching had a really positive impact on them.
- A total of 20 students per school received incentives such as laundry soap, pens, pencils and sharpeners. These were the final incentives as they graduated from the program. The team encouraged them to always speak out whenever they are faced with challenges. The mentors will always be available to listen, support and direct them accordingly. All the attendees got some snacks afterwards.
- Two teacher representatives per school were honored with appreciation cups for their dedication and support in implementing the program. This was meant to both appreciate and anchor them to continue cooperating with the team in making the program successful at their respective schools.

These ceremonies were not only celebratory but also reaffirmed the department's commitment to shaping responsible, informed, and confident youth across the community. Graduates were officially welcomed as Ambassadors of Hope, ready to share what they learned and influence their peers positively in schools and at home. The joy, pride, and gratitude displayed during these graduations were unforgettable.



Joyful Hope Spring graduands, featuring also are the teachers in charge of Hope Spring in various schools.

Conclusion

The month of July was truly a milestone for Kenya Keys as the organization celebrated not only its 20th Anniversary but also a series of impactful activities that reflected our shared mission of unlocking potential through education sponsorship and mentorship. The presence of the US team added great energy, support, and collaboration across departments, creating moments of deep connection.

From emotional student-sponsor reunions, to empowering team-building sessions, and the unforgettable Tsavo Safari each event contributed to a stronger, more unified Kenya Keys community. At the heart of it

all was the unwavering commitment to walk with our students through every stage of their educational journey.

We extend our sincere gratitude to all who made it possible, our students, sponsors, staff, partners, and the US team. Your continued support, belief, and involvement are what make this mission sustainable and impactful.

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